

Data Analyst

Real-World DAX Interview Questions



Top 10 Real-World DAX Interview Questions (with Examples)

1. Calculate Year-over-Year (YoY) Sales Growth

Question: How do you calculate the YoY growth in sales using DAX?

DAX Example:

YoY Sales =

```
CALCULATE(SUM(Sales[Amount]), SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR(Dates[Date]))
```

% Growth:

YoY Growth % =

```
DIVIDE([Total Sales] - [YoY Sales], [YoY Sales])
```

Real-World Use: Analyzing company sales growth over time.

2. Calculate Running Total / Cumulative Total

Question: How can you create a running total for monthly sales?

DAX Example:

Running Total =

```
CALCULATE(
    SUM(Sales[Amount]),
    FILTER(ALL(Dates[Date]), Dates[Date] <= MAX(Dates[Date]))
)
```

Real-World Use: Track cumulative revenue or expenses.

3. Top N Products by Sales

Question: How do you find the top 5 products by total sales?

DAX Example:

Top 5 Sales =

```
IF(
    RANKX(ALL(Products[Product Name]), [Total Sales], , DESC) <= 5,
    [Total Sales]
)
```

)

Real-World Use: Focus marketing on high-performing products.

4. Create Dynamic Titles Based on Filtered Data

Question: How can you make a dynamic title that updates based on slicer selection?

DAX Example:

Title =

"Sales Report for " & SELECTEDVALUE(Region[RegionName], "All Regions")

Real-World Use: Interactive dashboards for business users.

5. Calculate % of Total

Question: How do you calculate each category's contribution to total sales?

DAX Example:

% of Total Sales =

DIVIDE(SUM(Sales[Amount]), CALCULATE(SUM(Sales[Amount]), ALL(Sales)))

Real-World Use: Understand share of categories, segments, or regions.

6. Calculate Active Customers Over Time

Question: How many unique customers made purchases in a given period?

DAX Example:

Active Customers = DISTINCTCOUNT(Sales[CustomerID])

Real-World Use: Measure customer engagement and retention.

7. Calculate Profit Margin

Question: How do you calculate the profit margin?

DAX Example:

Profit Margin % =

DIVIDE(SUM(Sales[Profit]), SUM(Sales[Sales]))

Real-World Use: Evaluate profitability by product or region.

8. Find the Last Purchase Date of Each Customer

Question: How can you find the latest purchase date per customer?

DAX Example:

Last Purchase Date =

`CALCULATE(MAX(Sales[Order Date]), ALLEXCEPT(Sales, Sales[CustomerID]))`

Real-World Use: Segment loyal vs. inactive customers.

9. Calculate Average Sales Per Day

Question: How do you find average sales per working day?

DAX Example:

Avg Sales Per Day =

`DIVIDE(SUM(Sales[Amount]), DISTINCTCOUNT(Sales[Order Date]))`

Real-World Use: Normalize performance over different date ranges.

10. Handle Multiple Filters with CALCULATE and REMOVEFILTERS

Question: How do you ignore slicers/filters in a measure?

DAX Example:

Total Sales All Time =

`CALCULATE(SUM(Sales[Amount]), REMOVEFILTERS(Dates))`

Real-World Use: Show totals irrespective of user selections.

(Dipankar pal)

(www.linkedin.com/in/dipankar-data-analyst)